Preview for Linux and Windows

User Guide & Reference Manual

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A calm, readable, and comprehensive user guide for Preview on Linux and Windows. Covers document viewing, PDF navigation, annotation tools, image adjustments, signatures, redactions, and keyboard shortcuts.

1. Quick Start

1. Open a Document: Click Open on the toolbar or press Ctrl + O to choose any PDF or image.
2. Navigate Pages: Use Right Arrow and Left Arrow, or click the Sidebar button (Ctrl + B).
3. Zoom and Pan: Press Ctrl + 9 to fit window, or hold Spacebar and drag mouse to pan.
4. Annotate: Click the Markup button (Ctrl + Shift + A) to sketch, highlight, add text or notes.
5. Save or Export: Press Ctrl + S to save, or select File > Export... (Ctrl + E) to convert formats.

2. Window Overview

- **Menubar & Top Toolbar:**
  Contains traffic lights, page navigation, segmented Open control, zoom, rotate, markup toggle, search box, and inspector button.
- **Left Sidebar:**
  Displays vertical Thumbnails, multi-column Contact Sheet, or the Table of Contents outline tree. Includes a thumbnail size slider.
- **Canvas Viewport:**
  Smooth high-DPI rendering surface for PDFs and images with loupe magnifier and selection marquee interaction.
- **Markup Toolbar:**
  Secondary 38px utility bar providing sketch pen, highlighter, shapes, text box, sticky notes, redaction, signatures, and color swatches.

3. Feature Reference Table

Feature	Location / Shortcut	Description
Open & Recent	File > Open... (Ctrl+O)	Opens single PDF/image or multi-page image folders with recent history.
Sidebar & Outline	View > Toggle Sidebar (Ctrl+B)	Thumbnails, contact sheets, and chapter bookmarks with drag reordering.
Annotation & Markup	Tools > Show Markup Toolbar	Pen, highlighter, shapes, text, sticky notes, and line formatting.
Selection & Crop	Tools > Crop (Ctrl+K)	Rectangular, oval, and lasso cropping with 90° selection rotation.
Signature Pad	Markup Toolbar > Signatures	Smooth trackpad vector drawing pad with transparent PNG placement.
Redaction	Edit > Apply All Redactions	Permanent blackout sanitization destroying covered text and imagery.
Adjust Color	Tools > Adjust Color... (Ctrl+Alt+C)	Live RGB histogram with exposure, contrast, saturation, and tint sliders.
Adjust Size	Tools > Adjust Size... (Ctrl+Alt+S)	Pixel resampling and DPI resolution scaling with aspect ratio lock.
PDF Security	File > Set PDF Password...	AES-256 standard password encryption for confidential documents.
Export & Print	File > Export... (Ctrl+E)	Converts to PDF, PNG, JPEG, WebP, TIFF with quality and DPI options.

4. Keyboard Shortcuts Reference

File Operations

Open File	**Ctrl + O**
Open Folder of Images	**Ctrl + Shift + O**
Save Changes	**Ctrl + S**
Duplicate / Save As New Copy	**Ctrl + Shift + S**
Export as PDF	**Ctrl + Shift + E**
Export Dialog	**Ctrl + E**
Print Document	**Ctrl + P**
Close Window	**Ctrl + W**

Navigation & View

Next / Previous Page	**Right Arrow / Left Arrow**
First / Last Page	**Home / End**
Go to Page Dialog	**Ctrl + G**
Toggle Sidebar	**Ctrl + B**
Actual Size (100%)	**Ctrl + 0**
Zoom to Fit Window	**Ctrl + 9**
Zoom In / Zoom Out	**Ctrl + = / Ctrl + -**
Magnifier Loupe	**` (backtick) or ~**

Tools & Editing

Toggle Markup Toolbar	**Ctrl + Shift + A**
Crop Selection	**Ctrl + K**
Rotate Page Right	**Ctrl + R**
Rotate Selection 90°	**Ctrl + R (with marquee)**
Rotate Page Left	**Ctrl + L**
Adjust Color Panel	**Ctrl + Alt + C**
Adjust Size Panel	**Ctrl + Alt + S**
Show Inspector	**Ctrl + I**

5. Common Problems and Fixes

Problem: Tools are disabled or not responding

Cause: The secondary Markup Toolbar is hidden.
Fix: Click the Markup button on the top toolbar or press Ctrl + Shift + A to reveal tools.

Problem: Crop and Rotate Selection buttons stay grayed out

Cause: An active rectangular, oval, or lasso marquee has not been drawn.
Fix: Select a selection tool from the Markup Toolbar and drag across canvas first.

Problem: Unsaved document modifications are lost

Cause: The document was closed and Don't Save was clicked in the alert sheet.
Fix: Always click Save or press Enter. Use Ctrl + S frequently while editing.

Problem: Adjust Color does not change PDF vector text

Cause: Adjust Color operates on raster image pixels and photographic data.
Fix: Use the Highlighter tool or font formatting controls for text pages.

Problem: Password-protected PDF will not open

Cause: AES-256 encrypted documents require the security password to decrypt.
Fix: Enter the password provided by the document creator.